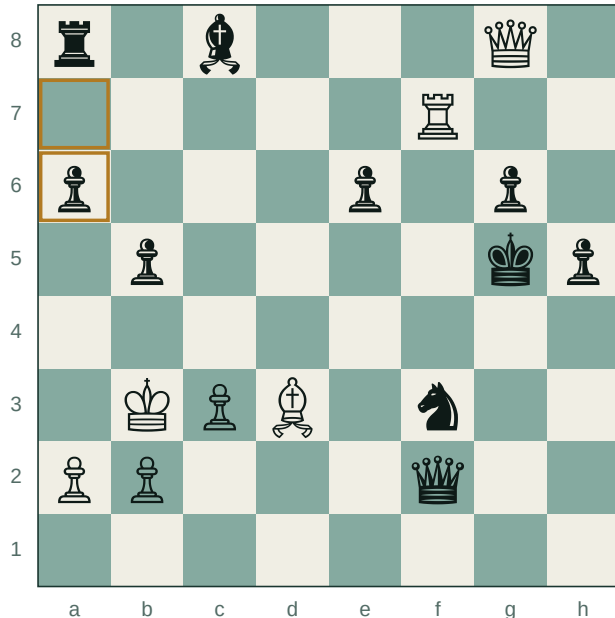


Deflection tactics: White, move 43

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 42...a6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

43. Qxg6+ Kh4 44. Rf4+ Kh3 45. Qxh5+

43.Qxg6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on g6. Recorded reply: **43...Kh4**.

44.Rf4+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From f4 it attacks king on h4 and knight on f3. Recorded reply: **44...Kh3**.

45.Qxh5+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. From h5 it attacks king on h3 and knight on f3.

At the end, nominal material is White 20 / Black 23 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +2: the balance goes from -5 to -3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g5. Absolute pin: pawn on g6.